

Asia Semiconductors and Equipment & Global Memory

Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co Ltd

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

2330.TT

3,300.00 TWD

TSM

554.00 USD



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TSMC: 3Q26 monthly sales tracking above consensus and guidance

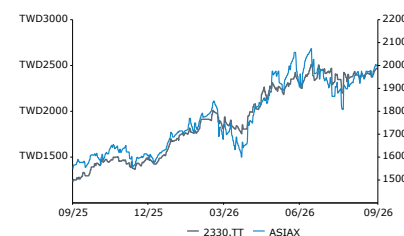
This afternoon TSMC reported August revenue at NT\$515B, up 10% MoM and 53% YoY. The revenue from July & August added up to NT\$982B, representing 68% of 3Q26 guidance mid-point. We used to compare this with the history of the past decade, but change to 2023-2025 as a new benchmark from this time as we note a shift in TSMC's monthly linearity in recent years likely due to the rise of AI (Exhibit 2). Should September follow this new seasonality, 3Q26 revenue would be c. 1% above guidance mid-point and consensus (Exhibit 1). Actual FX likely presented a 40bps tailwind and does not change the conclusion.

Higher revenue and capex on CPU ([report](#), [model](#)). Thanks to the growing agentic AI workload, CPU is emerging as a new growth driver for TSMC. We project its CPU revenue to hit US\$high-30sB, or mid-teens % of revenue in 2027, up from US\$15-16B in 2025. Meanwhile, we project TSMC's capex to rise from US\$64B this year, to US\$75B in 2027, & US\$82B in 2028, as we expect TSMC to build more front-end wafer capacity at N3/5/7 nodes. In contrast, we believe TSMC will moderate the expansion for CoWoS capacity & allow Amkor and ASE (both not covered) to contribute. Intel's EMIB will also fulfill some advanced packaging demand. We now forecast TSMC revenue in US\$ to grow by 41% this year and c. 30% CAGR over 2027-2028. With flattish margin assumptions, this translates into ~30% EPS CAGR over the next 2.5 years.

TSMC shares have been trading sideways around NT\$2,400 over the past 2 months, likely as investors shifted focus to other supply chain bottlenecks such as substrate and equipment. The stock is now trading at 19x forward P/E, on par with SOX and at 20% discount to the NASDAQ. With robust growth from data center AI now & optionality from edge AI later, we continue to view TSMC is a high-quality AI compounder. Reiterate **Outperform**.

Close Date	9 Sep 2026			
2330.TT Close Price (TWD)	2,465.00			
Price Target (TWD)	3,300.00			
Upside/(Downside)	34%			
52-Week Range	2,535.00/1,215.00			
ASIAx	2,001.58			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	1.1%			
Market Cap (TWD) (B)	63,923.29			
EV (TWD) (B)	61,512.18			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	59.0	3.6	33.2	101.2
ASIAx (%)	22.4	3.9	15.6	29.5
Relative (%)	36.6	(0.3)	17.6	71.8
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.				

Price Performance, 1YR



Reported EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
2330.TT (TWD)	66.25	110.70	144.85	Revenues (M)	3,809*	5,457*	7,328*	38.7%	P/B (x)	11.8	8.4	6.3
TSM (USD)	10.28	17.18	22.48	CapEx (M)	1,272*	2,016*	2,370*	36.5%	Reported P/E (x)	37.2	22.3	17.0
				Gross Margin (%)	59.9	66.1	64.5	--	Div Yield (%)	0.4	0.4	0.5
				Operating Margin (%)	50.8	58.3	56.6	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	37.2	22.3	17.0
				Net Income Margin (%)	45.1	52.6	51.3	--	PEG Adjusted (x)	0.8	0.3	0.6
				ROE (%)	35.1	43.9	42.2	--	EV/FCF (x)	61.4	35.4	23.2
				Net Debt/Equity (x)	(0.31)	(0.37)	(0.42)	--	EV/EBITDA (x)	23.4	15.3	11.7

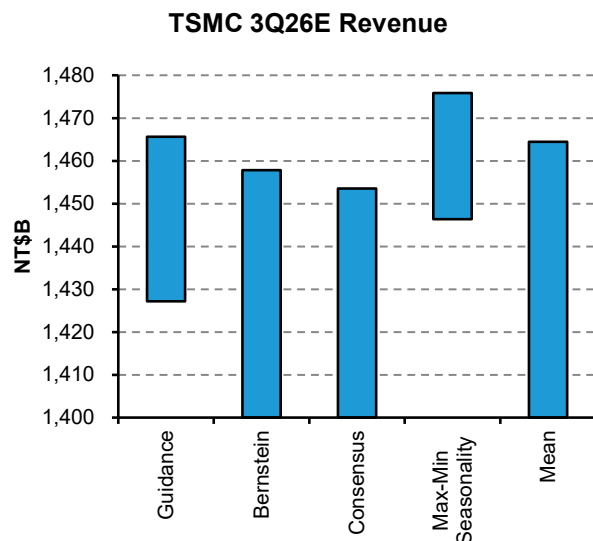
*Values shown in billions; Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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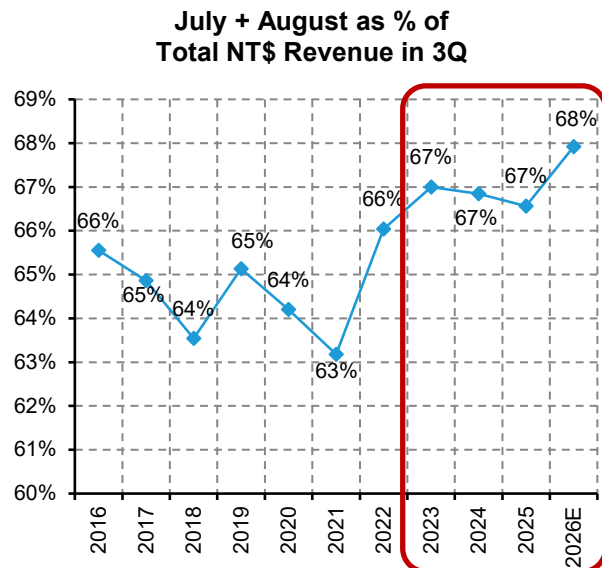
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EXHIBIT 1: Should September follow seasonality, 3Q26 revenue would be c. 1% above the guidance midpoint and consensus.



*Maximum, minimum, and mean seasonality is based on 2023-2025 historical.
Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 2: The revenue of July + August vs. 3Q26 guidance mid-point came in higher than the historical range.



2026 data is based on July + August sales as % of the mid-point of 3Q26 revenue guidance

Source: Company report, Bernstein estimates and analysis

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate TSMC **Outperform**. Price target is **NT\$3,300.00**.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	9 Sep 2026		TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				P/B (x)		
			Closing Price	Price Target		Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
2330.TT (TSMC)	O	TWD	2,465.00	3,300.00	71.8%	TWD	66.25	110.70	144.85	11.8	8.4	6.3
TSM (TSMC)	O	USD	435.36	554.00	56.3%	USD	10.28	17.18	22.48	13.4	9.6	7.2
ASIAAX			2,001.58									
SPX			7,636.36									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co Ltd**

We set a NT\$3,300 1-year target price using a P/E multiple of 20x against our forward Q5-Q8 EPS estimate of NT\$164. We derive our PT for secondary ticker (TSM.US) by dividing the primary PT by FX and arrive at US\$554.

RISKS**Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co Ltd**

Downside risks are: (1) Market-wide multiple contraction. (2) Intel regains and keeps technology superiority. (3) Geopolitical uncertainties

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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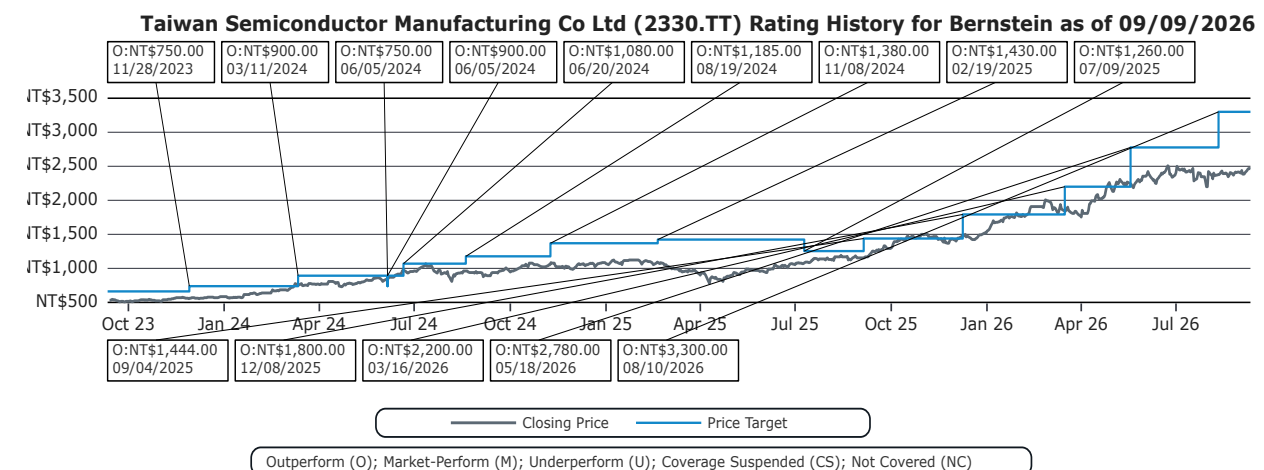
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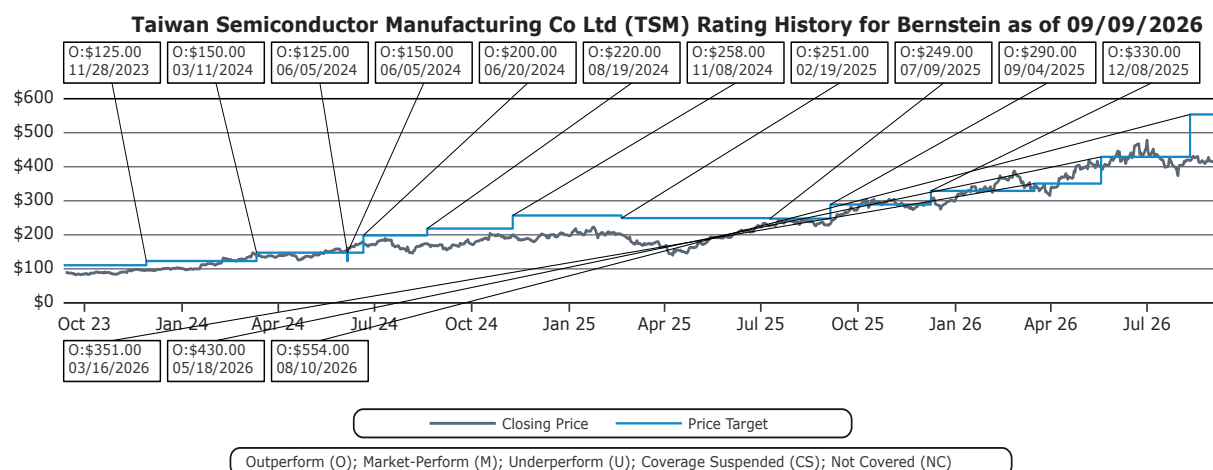
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Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

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